
Pearl Millet


Finger Millet


Sorghum

Figure 10.2: Millets

Finger Millet – Ragi

Botanical name : *Eleusine coracana*

Origin and Area of Cultivation

Finger millet is the crop of early introduction from East Africa into India. Ragi is rich in calcium.

Uses

It is used as a staple food in many southern hilly regions of India. Ragi grains are made into porridge and gruel. Ragi malt is the popular nutrient drink. It is used as a source of fermented beverages.

Sorghum

Botanical name : *Sorghum vulgare*

Origin and Area of Cultivation

Sorghum is native to Africa. It is one of the major millets in the world and is rich in calcium and iron.

Uses

It is fed to poultry, birds, pigs and cattle and a source of fermented alcoholic beverage

10.1.3 Minor Millets

Little Millet

Botanical name- *Panicum sumatrense*

Origin and Area of Cultivation

This is one of the oldest millets and is native to India. The species name is based on a specimen collected from Sumatra. It is rich in iron and fibre than rice that makes it best for diabetes.

Uses

It is cooked like rice and also milled and baked. It cures anaemic condition, constipation and other gastrological problems.

Foxtail Millet

Botanical name : *Setaria italica*

Origin and Area of Cultivation

This is one of the oldest millet used traditionally in India. Which is domesticated first in China about 6000 years. Rich in protein, carbohydrate, vitamin B and C, Potassium and Calcium.

Uses

It supports in strengthening of heart and improves eye sight. Thinai porridge is given to lactating mother.

Kodo Millet

Botanical name : *Paspalum scrobiculatum*

Origin and Area of Cultivation

Kodo millet is originated from West Africa, which is rich in fibre, protein and minerals.

Uses

Kodo millet is ground into flour and used to make pudding. Good diuretic and cures constipation. Helps to reduce obesity, blood sugar and blood pressure.

10.1.4 Pulses

The word Pulse is derived from the Latin words 'puls' or 'pultis' meaning "thick soup". Pulses are the edible seeds that are harvested from the fruits of Fabaceae. They provide vital source of plant-based protein, vitamins and minerals for people around the globe.


Little Millet


Foxtail Millet


Kodo Millet

Figure 10.3: Minor Millets

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